

customers can browse and interact with virtual products. Hyper-realistic visuals and accurate representations enable users to inspect products in detail, try on virtual clothing, or even simulate the placement of furniture in their homes. This seamless integration of virtual and physical experiences enhances the online shopping journey, increases customer satisfaction, and opens up new avenues for personalised marketing and product visualisation.

Healthcare and telemedicine. In the realm of healthcare, hyper-real platforms can revolutionise telemedicine and patient care. Virtual consultations can be conducted within hyper-realistic environments, allowing healthcare professionals to interact with patients in a more immersive and intuitive manner. Hyper-real platforms also enable medical simulations, where doctors can practice complex procedures and scenarios in virtual environments. This technology enhances medical training, facilitates remote collaboration among experts, and improves patient outcomes by enabling accurate diagnosis and treatment.

Economic opportunities and business models

Hyper-real platforms, that aim to create highly realistic and immersive experiences, play a crucial role in unlocking the full potential of the metaverse. Some of the economic opportunities in implementing hyper-real platforms with the metaverse are detailed below (see Table 2).

Virtual real estate and property development. One significant economic opportunity in the metaverse lies in virtual real estate and property development. Hyper-real platforms enable the creation of lifelike virtual environments that can be owned, developed, and

monetised. Entrepreneurs and businesses can acquire virtual land and build virtual properties, including homes, commercial spaces, entertainment venues, and more. These virtual assets can be leased, rented, or sold to other users, creating a virtual real estate market and opening avenues for property development, design, architecture, and virtual construction services.

Digital goods and virtual asset marketplace. Hyper-real platforms offer a thriving marketplace for digital goods and virtual assets within the metaverse. Users can create, buy, sell, and trade a wide range of virtual items, including clothing, accessories, vehicles, artwork, and more. Artists, designers, and content creators can leverage hyper-real platforms to design and sell virtual products, tapping into a global market of metaverse users. Additionally, the scarcity and exclusivity of limited-edition virtual assets can drive demand and create unique economic opportunities.

Virtual events and experiences. Hyper-real platforms provide a fertile ground for hosting virtual events and experiences. Businesses can organise concerts, conferences, exhibitions, and immersive storytelling experiences within hyper-realistic virtual environments. Virtual event organisers can generate revenue through ticket sales, sponsorships, merchandise, and partnerships. Hyper-real platforms offer unique advantages, such as global accessibility, reduced logistical constraints, and the ability to create memorable and interactive experiences that transcend physical limitations.

Advertising and brand integration. As the metaverse becomes more populated and immersive, advertising and brand integration present significant economic opportunities. Brands can leverage hyper-real platforms to create

immersive advertising campaigns, product placements, and branded experiences within virtual environments. Businesses can establish virtual storefronts or integrate their products and services into the fabric of the metaverse, engaging with users in novel and interactive ways. Virtual advertising spaces, sponsored events, and partnerships can drive revenue streams and establish brand presence in the metaverse.

Virtual services and consultation. Professionals can provide virtual consulting services, ranging from design and architecture to healthcare and education. Virtual experts can offer personalised guidance, training, and mentorship, leveraging the immersive and interactive nature of hyper-real platforms. The virtual service economy within the metaverse can encompass a wide range of industries, unlocking new revenue streams and expanding access to expertise on a global scale.

Platform development and infrastructure. The development and maintenance of hyper-real platforms themselves present economic opportunities. Companies can specialise in building and maintaining the underlying infrastructure, including servers, networking, security, and content delivery platforms. Additionally, developers and creators can build and sell tools, plugins, and assets for hyper-real platforms, catering to the needs of other businesses and users within the metaverse ecosystem.

As hyper-real platforms continue to evolve, the possibilities in the metaverse are boundless. From lifelike gaming adventures to immersive architectural walkthroughs and experiential learning, the future holds exciting transformations that will reshape our digital world. **EFY**

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